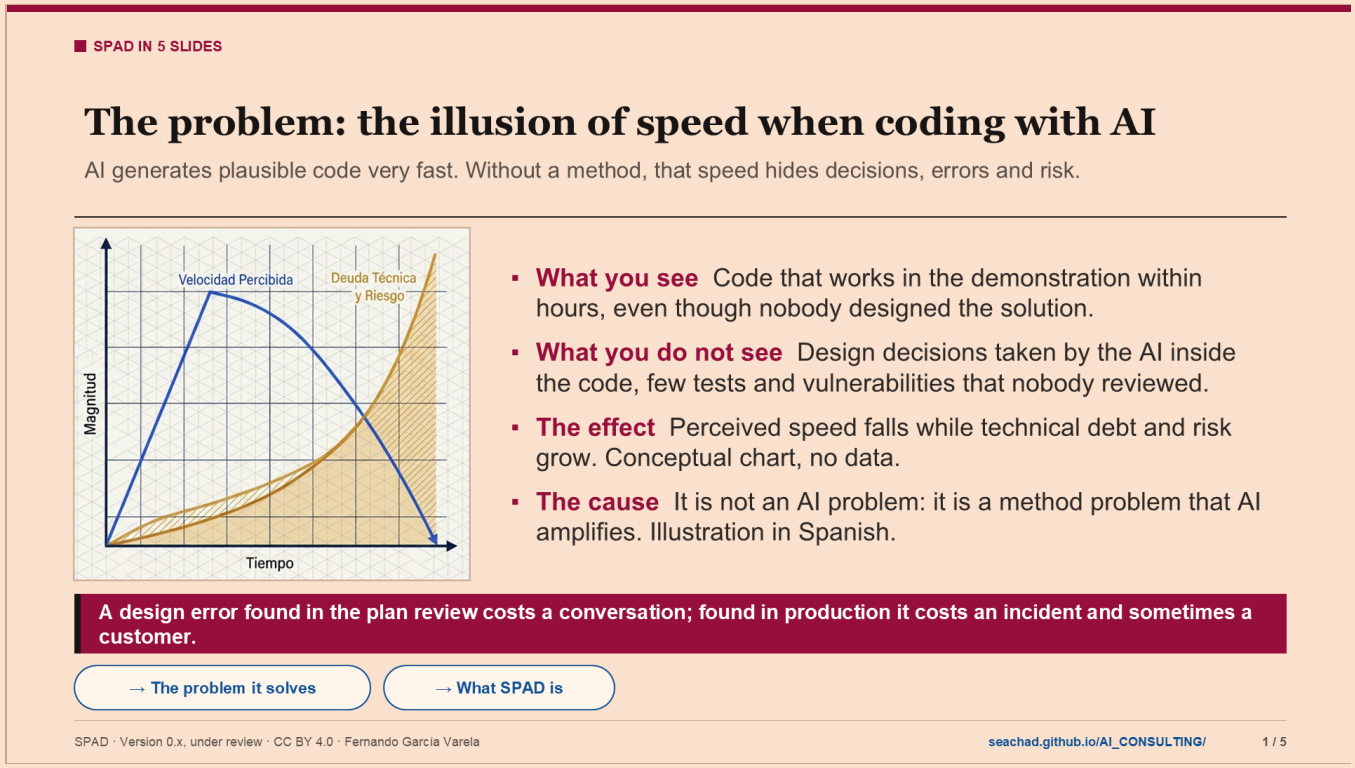


Notes

SPAD stands for Structured Prompt-Driven Engineering. It is a way of working to build software with the help of AI in a controlled manner, so that the work can be reviewed, reproduced and audited.

The chart is conceptual and has no data. It shows an intuition: at first, coding with AI looks much faster. Over time, if nobody designs, nobody reviews and nothing is written down, perceived speed falls while technical debt and risk grow.

Typical symptoms that SPAD addresses:

- The code works in the demonstration and fails in production, because code was requested until it «worked».
- Nobody knows why the system is built this way, because the AI took the decisions inside the code.
- Vulnerabilities appear, because the same AI that wrote the code reviewed it, or nobody did.
- An audit asks for evidence of the development and there is none: the work stayed in conversations with the AI.

A simple example: a team asks an AI assistant for a payments screen. It works in one afternoon. Nobody has decided how retries are handled or who can see the data. The failure appears months later, in front of a customer.

Why it matters to an executive: speed without control moves the cost into the future, as incidents, rework and reputational or regulatory risk. SPAD does not promise improvement figures; each organisation measures its effect against its own starting position.

Question for the classroom: who in your organisation could explain today why an application generated with AI is built the way it is?

SOURCES AND LINKS

SPAD IN 5 SLIDES

- **SPAD 00 · What SPAD is and what it is for, section 2** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/00_SPAD_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html#the-problem-it-solves
- **SPAD 00 · When to use SPAD** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/00_SPAD_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html#when-to-use-spad
- **The problem it solves** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/00_SPAD_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html#the-problem-it-solves
- **What SPAD is** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/00_SPAD_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html



Notes

SPAD has three properties. It is sequential: work advances through phases in a fixed order. It is blocking: no phase starts until the previous one has produced its result and a person has validated it. It is auditable: each phase leaves a written artefact (a plan, a review report, a test strategy, a release record) that is kept.

The first three cards are the three pillars: think, validate and execute. The other three are non-negotiable rules. The operational guide sets out twelve, among them:

- Every decision is explicit: there are no design decisions hidden in the code.
- Minimal fixes: surgical and justified, never disguised rewrites.
- Mandatory tests, with minimum coverage set before building.
- Security by design: sensitive code undergoes a security review and critical and high findings block.
- Model recorded: each artefact states which model and which instructions produced it.

The principle that orders everything: compliance with the flow is more important than the apparent quality of the result. A technically correct response that breaks the rules of its phase is discarded in its entirety and the phase is repeated. Example: a plan is requested and the AI adds «an example implementation» of five hundred lines. Even if the code is good, the response is invalid.

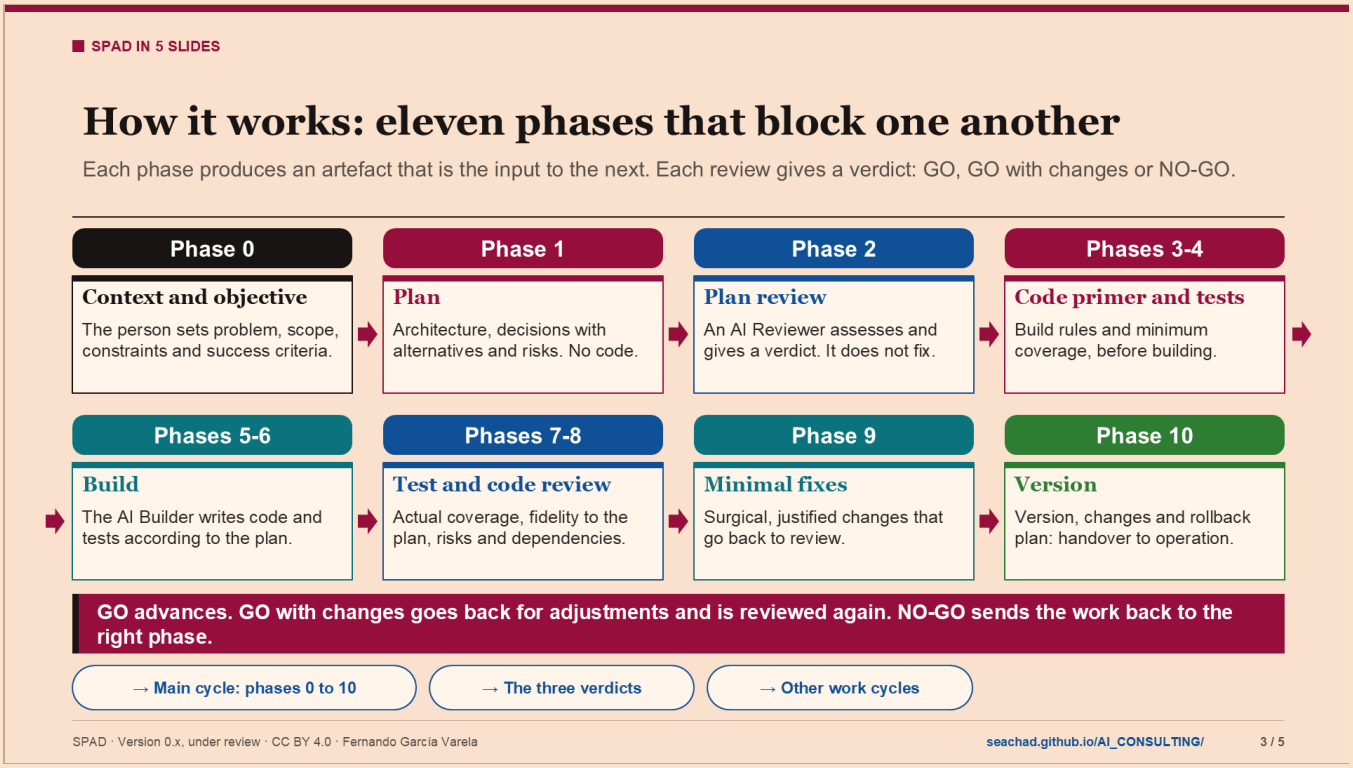
Why it matters to an executive: if a response that breaks the rules is accepted «just this once» because the code works, the process stops existing. Discipline is what makes the evidence reliable.

Question for the classroom: which rule on this slide would a team in a hurry find hardest to follow, and why?

SOURCES AND LINKS

- **SPAD 00 · The principle that orders everything** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/00_SPAD_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html#the-principle-that-orders-everything
- **SPAD 01 · Non-negotiable operating rules** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/01_SPAD_Guia_operativa.html#non-negotiable-operating-rules

- **SPAD 03 · Validation policy, examples of decisions** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/03_SPAD_Politica_de_validacion.html#examples-of-decisions
- **The principle that orders everything** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/00_SPAD_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html#the-principle-that-orders-everything
- **The twelve non-negotiable rules** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/01_SPAD_Guia_operativa.html#non-negotiable-operating-rules
- **Validation policy** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/03_SPAD_Politica_de_validacion.html



Notes

The main cycle is used to build a new feature and has eleven phases, from 0 to 10. The slide groups some of them so they can be read at a glance.

- Phase 0, context and objective: without success criteria there is no phase 1.
- Phase 1, plan: the AI Planner designs without writing code and records the alternatives it discarded.
- Phase 2, plan review: a different AI assesses coupling, scalability, security and other aspects. It assesses; it does not fix.
- Phases 3 and 4, code primer and test strategy: these are the most often skipped and the ones that protect most value. The primer stops the builder from deciding; the strategy prevents tests from being written at the end just to confirm what already exists.
- Phases 5 and 6, build: if the plan does not foresee a situation, the AI Builder does not decide; it flags it and a person resolves it.
- Phases 7 and 8, reviews: they include the dependencies added and their licence.
- Phase 9, fixes: each fix goes back to the code review.
- Phase 10, version: the system is ready to operate, with a deployment and rollback plan.

The verdicts are always the same: GO (work advances), GO with changes (adjust and review again) and NO-GO (redo). A NO-GO in the plan review sends work back to phase 0, because the problem is badly framed. A well-founded NO-GO is not a failure: it is the process working.

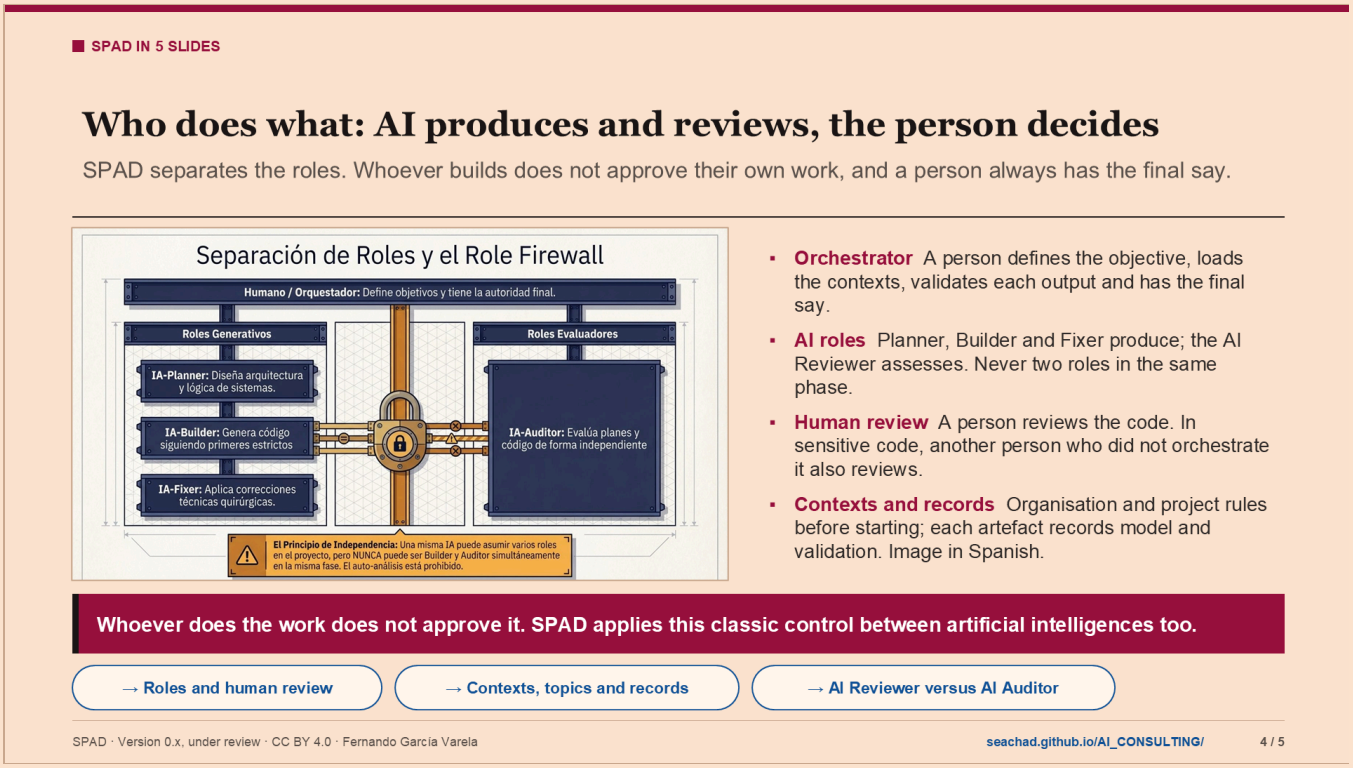
There are also cycles for legacy code, debugging, urgent fixes and security. In an emergency the phases are accelerated, but review and tests remain mandatory.

Why it matters to an executive: the cycle brings expensive decisions forward to the moment when they are still cheap.

SOURCES AND LINKS

SPAD IN 5 SLIDES

- **SPAD 01 · Main cycle: phases 0 to 10** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/01_SPAD_Guia_operativa.html#main-cycle-phases-0-to-10
- **SPAD 01 · Verdicts** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/01_SPAD_Guia_operativa.html#verdicts
- **SPAD 00 · Other work cycles** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/00_SPAD_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html#other-work-cycles
- **Main cycle: phases 0 to 10** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/01_SPAD_Guia_operativa.html#main-cycle-phases-0-to-10
- **The three verdicts** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/01_SPAD_Guia_operativa.html#verdicts
- **Other work cycles** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/00_SPAD_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html#other-work-cycles



Notes

SPAD distinguishes logical roles, not specific people or tools. The same AI may take on several roles in a piece of work, but never two in the same phase, and the AI that reviews an artefact is never the one that produced it.

- The Orchestrator is a person. They define the objective, load the contexts, set the topic, validate each output and decide whether to advance. They cannot delegate validation to the AI that produced the output.
- The AI Planner designs and does not write code. The AI Builder writes code and does not take design decisions. The AI Fixer applies minimal fixes and does not redesign.
- The AI Reviewer assesses and does not fix. The illustration labels it «IA-Auditor»: it is the AI Reviewer. It must not be confused with the SEVEN-G AI Auditor, who is an independent person.

Two artificial intelligences can make the same mistake. That is why a competent person also reviews the code before it is merged. In authentication, payments, personal data, agents or critical systems, a second person who did not orchestrate the generation also reviews.

Contexts: before any phase, the organisation's rules (for example, «no real personal data in instructions to external providers») and the project's rules are loaded. Topic: a short name that groups all the artefacts of a piece of work in one folder. Records: each artefact states which model produced it, who validated it and with what result; and each discarded response is logged.

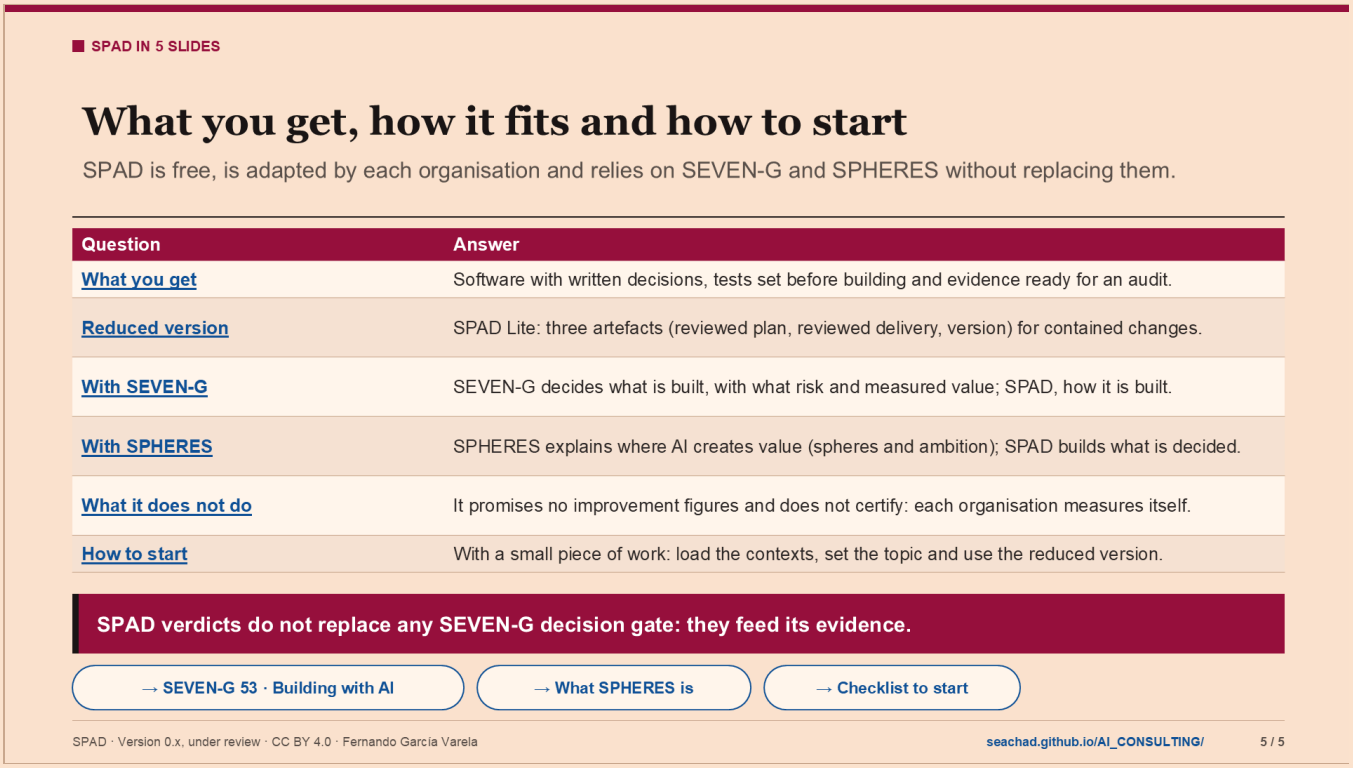
Why it matters to an executive: this is the segregation of duties of any serious process. The person who answers to the organisation for the code being correct is a person, and that responsibility is not delegated to a tool.

Question for the classroom: which data of your company should never reach an external AI tool?

SOURCES AND LINKS

SPAD IN 5 SLIDES

- **SPAD 01 · Roles and human code review** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/01_SPAD_Guia_operativa.html#3-1-human-code-review
- **SPAD 02 · Global context** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/02_SPAD_Contextos_temas_y_registro.html#2-1-global-context
- **SPAD 02 · Records per artefact** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/02_SPAD_Contextos_temas_y_registro.html#records-per-artefact
- **SEVEN-G 53 · AI Reviewer versus AI Auditor** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/html/en/53_SEVEN-G_Construccion_de_soluciones_con_IA.html#roles-ai-reviewer-versus-ai-auditor
- **Roles and human review** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/01_SPAD_Guia_operativa.html#roles
- **Contexts, topics and records** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/02_SPAD_Contextos_temas_y_registro.html
- **AI Reviewer versus AI Auditor** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/html/en/53_SEVEN-G_Construccion_de_soluciones_con_IA.html#roles-ai-reviewer-versus-ai-auditor



SPAD IN 5 SLIDES

What you get, how it fits and how to start

SPAD is free, is adapted by each organisation and relies on SEVEN-G and SPHERES without replacing them.

Question	Answer
What you get	Software with written decisions, tests set before building and evidence ready for an audit.
Reduced version	SPAD Lite: three artefacts (reviewed plan, reviewed delivery, version) for contained changes.
With SEVEN-G	SEVEN-G decides what is built, with what risk and measured value; SPAD, how it is built.
With SPHERES	SPHERES explains where AI creates value (spheres and ambition); SPAD builds what is decided.
What it does not do	It promises no improvement figures and does not certify: each organisation measures itself.
How to start	With a small piece of work: load the contexts, set the topic and use the reduced version.

SPAD verdicts do not replace any SEVEN-G decision gate: they feed its evidence.

→ SEVEN-G 53 · Building with AI | → What SPHERES is | → Checklist to start

SPAD · Version 0.x, under review · CC BY 4.0 · Fernando García Varela seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/ 5 / 5

Notes

What you get: decisions taken before code is written, one artefact per phase, independent reviews and traceable fixes. Everything is kept in the topic folder, which is the unit of audit. The organisation can carry out a self-assessment of conformity, by a person independent of those who built. It is not a certification: nobody issues or endorses it from outside.

Reduced version (SPAD Lite): it groups the phases into three artefacts. It suits contained changes, with no personal data or money, and a small team. What is never cut is the separation between the AI that builds and the one that reviews, human validation, the validation policy and the topic register. Sensitive code, agents with high autonomy and critical systems require the complete version.

How it relies on SEVEN-G (document 53): SEVEN-G governs the complete AI initiative, that is, what is built, with what risk and with what measured value, and people decide at decision gates. SPAD works inside the build, mainly in the design and delivery phases. A SPAD GO does not equal «Proceed» at a SEVEN-G gate: its artefacts are inputs to the evidence. SEVEN-G accepts SPAD or another documented method that meets its minimum requirements.

Relationship with SPHERES: SPHERES explains the nine spheres where AI creates value and the three ambition levels (Optimise, Augment, Transform). It helps decide where to invest; SPAD helps build well what has been decided. They are independent methodologies that reference each other.

How to start: choose a small piece of work; load the global and project contexts; set the topic; assign an AI Reviewer different from the builder; open the validation record; and check which information may be sent to each provider. At first it will be slower; measure rework and incidents against your starting position.

SPAD is published under CC BY 4.0 (content) and MIT (code); using it is free.

SOURCES AND LINKS

- **SEVEN-G 53 · Relationship between SEVEN-G and SPAD** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/html/en/53_SEVEN-G_Construccion_de_soluciones_con_IA.html#relationship-between-seven-g-and-spad

SPAD IN 5 SLIDES

- **SEVEN-G 53 · Technical verdicts and gate outcomes** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/html/en/53_SEVEN-G_Construccion_de_soluciones_con_IA.html#4-4-technical-verdicts-and-gate-outcomes
- **SPAD 01 · Reduced version (SPAD Lite)** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/01_SPAD_Guia_operativa.html#reduced-version-spad-lite
- **SPAD 08 · Self-assessment and process metrics** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/08_SPAD_Autoevaluacion_y_metricas.html#process-metrics
- **SPHERES 00 · What SPHERES is and what it is for** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPHERES/html/en/00_SPHERES_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html
- **SEVEN-G 53 · Building with AI** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SEVEN-G/html/en/53_SEVEN-G_Construccion_de_soluciones_con_IA.html
- **What SPHERES is** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPHERES/html/en/00_SPHERES_Que_es_y_para_que_sirve.html
- **Checklist to start** https://seachad.github.io/AI_CONSULTING/SPAD/html/en/02_SPAD_Contextos_temas_y_registro.html#checklist-before-starting

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